

Podcast Producer & Episode Management Tracker Guide

What This Tracker Is For

Running a podcast means juggling multiple moving pieces at once: guest outreach, episode scheduling, recording dates, editing deadlines, sponsorship deals, and publication timelines. The Podcast Producer & Episode Management Tracker helps you keep all of those details in one place so nothing falls through the cracks. By maintaining a clear record of each episode from initial guest outreach through publication, you stay organized and can quickly see the status of any episode at a glance.

How to Use Each Column

Date: The calendar date when you made the log entry. Use this for record-keeping and to track when you took actions (outreach sent, guest confirmed, recording completed, etc.).

Notes: A brief label or action memo—"Initial outreach sent," "Guest confirmed," "Recording scheduled," "Awaiting editing files." This helps you quickly understand what stage the episode is at and what action you took on that date.

Episode Number: The sequential episode number for your show. If you track multiple seasons, include the season if helpful (e.g., "S2E45").

Episode Title: The planned or final title of the episode. Update this if the title changes during production.

Guest Name: The name of the guest (or "Solo" if no guest). Use the name as it will appear in show notes and promotion.

Guest Email: The guest's primary contact email. This is where you send prep materials, recording links, and follow-up messages.

Guest Confirmation Status: Track where the guest is in your booking workflow. Examples: "pending" (awaiting response), "interested" (expressed interest but not confirmed), "confirmed" (locked in), "recorded" (session completed). Update as the relationship progresses.

Recording Date: The planned or completed recording date. Schedule this as soon as you confirm the guest.

Recording Time: The time of day for the recording session (e.g., "14:00," "2:30 PM"). This helps guests know exactly when to log in or call, and serves as a reference if scheduling changes.

Editing Deadline: The date by which editing must be complete for the episode to stay on schedule for publication. Set this deadline based on your typical editing timeline and publish schedule.

Publish Date: The target publication date for the episode. This drives all other deadlines upstream (recording must happen well before this, editing must be done in time).

Publish Status: The current stage of publication. Examples: "scheduled" (queued to go live), "in_editing," "awaiting_files" (waiting for guest materials or final recordings), "not_recorded" (guest and date confirmed but recording hasn't happened yet). Update as the episode moves through production.

Sponsorship Deal: Any sponsorship or brand deal associated with this episode. Examples: "TechCorp \$500," "Creator Fund \$250," or "None." Track the sponsor name and payment amount if relevant.

Affiliate Links: Any affiliate or promotional codes you're using for this episode. Example: "Zapier (code: PODCAST20)," "Loom (affiliate)." This helps you track which tools or partners are monetized in each episode.

Episode Length (min): The runtime of the episode in minutes. Record this after recording is complete or estimate it beforehand. Useful for show notes, artwork, and listener expectations.

Show Notes Link: The URL where your show notes live for this episode. This can be a link to your website, Notion page, or wherever you host episode details, transcripts, and guest information.

Promotion Status: Track how far you've come in promoting the episode. Examples: "social_draft" (promo graphics created), "social_queued" (ready to post), "social_posted" (live on social media), "email_sent" (included in newsletter), "not_started." This helps ensure you don't miss promotional deadlines.

Listener Count: The number of listeners or downloads for the episode (if you track this). Leave blank until the episode publishes, then update with actual numbers from your analytics.

Why Consistent Tracking Helps Podcast Producers

Podcast production involves many parallel workflows. You might be outreaching to guests for episode 165 while recording episode 162 and editing episode 160.

Without a clear record, it's easy to lose track of which guest you need to follow up with, when recording sessions are scheduled, or which episode's deadline is coming up next week.

By logging each episode's journey through your production pipeline, you can quickly answer questions like: "Which guests still need confirmation?" "What's my publishing schedule for the next four weeks?" "Did I send promo materials to this sponsor?" "Which episode is furthest behind?" This tracker turns scattered notes and half-remembered conversations into a clear, actionable timeline.

The tracker also serves as a reference for sponsor and affiliate partner tracking. When you can see which episodes have deals, how much revenue they represent, and whether promotional codes are actually live, you have better visibility into the business side of your podcast. Over time, this data helps you understand which sponsor types resonate with your audience and which promotional strategies work best.

How to Stay Organized

Update the tracker daily or whenever something changes—a guest confirms, a recording completes, a deadline shifts, or promotional work is done. The more current your tracker stays, the more useful it becomes as your single source of truth for episode status. Review it weekly to spot episodes that are falling behind, guests who haven't responded, or promotional windows you're about to miss.

This tracker is a practical tool for keeping your podcast organized and on schedule. Use it to reduce the mental load of juggling multiple episodes, coordinate seamlessly with guests and sponsors, and ensure nothing important slips through the cracks.